

Monday, 28 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

20° 13°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

17° 10°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

17° 9°

GLASGOW

Overcast

16° 9°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 **Andy Burnham is proposing a radical overhaul of social care in England, suggesting an NHS-style system to make it fairer.**

The Prime Minister has openly criticised the current state of social care, calling it 'as unfair as American healthcare'. Burnham's detailed plan for a new service will be a key part of the next general election.

POLITICS · UK

- 2 **Thousands of homes are without water and roads are closed in parts of England after a major burst pipe this morning.**

Southern Water is investigating the incident, which occurred on Sunday morning. Residents in affected areas are being advised on where to find bottled water supplies.

INFRASTRUCTURE · UK

- 3 **A murder investigation has been launched after a cyclist died following a moped crash in London.**

Met Police believe the moped had been pursuing the e-bike cyclist before the collision. Officers are appealing for witnesses and anyone with dashcam footage to come forward.

CRIME · UK

- 4 **Ten NHS staff members have been removed from duties after a data breach involving patient Noah Woods.**

East Suffolk and North Essex NHS Foundation Trust has launched an urgent investigation into the breach. Patient confidentiality is paramount, and the trust is taking the matter very seriously.

HEALTHCARE · UK

- 5 **A star from the TV show The Traitors has been burgled after sharing holiday photos online.**

Paul Gorton urged people to think carefully before posting holiday pictures before they've returned home. It's a stark reminder of the risks of oversharing on social media.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

- 1 The hugely popular reality show *The Traitors* returns this Thursday with a brand new celebrity cast.**
Twenty-one stars will be vying to win a whopping £100,000 for their chosen charities. Get ready for more intrigue, deception, and dramatic banishments!
| ON AIR – Who are you backing to be the ultimate Traitor or Faithful this series?
TV · THIS WEEK
- 2 The shortlist for this year's prestigious Booker Prize has been revealed, following a 'tussle' among judges.**
Past winners Marlon James and Douglas Stuart are among the nominees for the literary award. The winner will be announced next month.
| ON AIR – Have you read any of the shortlisted novels, or do you have a favourite author you hope will win?
BOOKS · UPCOMING
- 3 Catherine Zeta-Jones has revealed her new film role is based on the funny Welsh people she knows.**
She plays Jackie Price, a former cocaine dealer targeted by assassins, in the film 'Kill Jackie'. Catherine says she drew on her Welsh roots for the character.
| ON AIR – What kind of role would you love to see Catherine Zeta-Jones take on next?
FILM · UPCOMING
- 4 Rapper Macklemore has announced a 'Free Palestine' tour, with proceeds going to support Palestinian organisations.**
The tour, which begins in Dublin next month, follows recent controversy involving the artist. He's been vocal about his support for the cause.
| ON AIR – What are your thoughts on artists using their platform for political activism?
MUSIC · UPCOMING
- 5 An Indian film from Nagaland is making waves globally and is now on a path towards the Oscars.**
Angh, which recently had a major win at Toronto, brings a rarely seen world to global cinema. It's fantastic to see such diverse storytelling gaining international recognition.
| ON AIR – Do you enjoy discovering films from different parts of the world, or do you tend to stick to more mainstream cinema?
FILM · UPCOMING

On the schedule

1 **The Premier League faces uncertainty and potential chaos following the verdict on Manchester City's financial charges.**

After more than two years, a judgment has been made on the 115 charges against the club. The football world is now waiting to see what the sanctions could be.

ON AIR – What do you think the punishment should be for Manchester City, and could this change the landscape of the Premier League?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **England have wrapped up their summer with an ODI series win over Sri Lanka, thanks to a brilliant century from Tom Banton.**

Banton delivered on his potential, crashing his first international century to secure the series victory. It's a fantastic end to the season for the England team.

ON AIR – After this performance, do you think Tom Banton has secured his place in the England squad for future series?

CRICKET · UK

3 **Fresh uncertainty surrounds the proposed Tyson Fury versus Anthony Joshua fight, according to Dana White.**

The UFC president cast doubt on whether the highly anticipated boxing match would actually happen. Fans have been eagerly awaiting this heavyweight clash.

ON AIR – Do you think we'll ever see Tyson Fury and Anthony Joshua face off in the ring, or will this fight remain a pipe dream?

BOXING · UK

4 **England's Matt Fitzpatrick has secured his fourth title of the season with a three-shot win at the French Open.**

His impressive performance in Paris solidifies a fantastic year for the golfer. Fitzpatrick continues to be a dominant force on the European tour.

ON AIR – How highly do you rate Matt Fitzpatrick among the current crop of British golfers?

GOLF · UK

5 **Saracens edged out Leicester Tigers in a thrilling match, despite a second-half red card for Nick Isiekwe.**

They began the Brendan Venter era with a narrow 40-38 victory. It was a dramatic start to the new season for both teams.

ON AIR – What impact do you think Brendan Venter will have on Saracens this season, and are they title contenders?

RUGBY · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The delightful resurgence of 'retro arcade game cafes' is bringing back a wave of nostalgia for gamers young and old.**
These welcoming spots combine classic coin-operated machines with a relaxed cafe atmosphere, offering a fun, interactive way to socialise and relive childhood memories.
- 2 New research suggests that 'mindful window gazing' can significantly reduce stress and boost creativity.**
Taking a few minutes each day to simply observe the world outside, without distraction, allows the mind to wander and find new perspectives, much like a mini-meditation.
- 3 The trend for 'upcycling old furniture into pet beds' is proving a hit with environmentally conscious pet owners.**
Creative individuals are transforming forgotten chests of drawers or suitcases into cosy, stylish resting places for their furry friends, giving new life to old items.
- 4 A study highlights the surprising benefits of 'listening to nature sounds' for improving focus during work or study.**
The gentle sounds of rainfall, ocean waves, or birdsong can create a calming background, masking distractions and helping concentration without being intrusive.
- 5 The charming practice of 'decorating front doors with seasonal wreaths' is seeing a burst of artistic flair.**
Beyond traditional Christmas displays, people are now crafting beautiful wreaths for every season, using natural elements to welcome guests with a touch of charm.
- 6 Experts are praising the simple joy of 'exploring local footpaths' as a fantastic way to boost both physical and mental well-being.**
Discovering hidden trails and green spaces close to home offers a refreshing escape, connecting us with nature and our communities without needing to travel far.
- 7 The delightful art of 'homemade cordials and fruit syrups' is experiencing a sweet revival amongst home cooks.**
Using seasonal fruits, people are creating their own delicious, natural drinks to mix with sparkling water or use in cocktails, avoiding artificial ingredients.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of jam will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?

ANSWER: GENTLY TILTING THE JAR FROM SIDE TO SIDE TO SEE HOW QUICKLY IT MOVES, ASSUMING A SLOWER SLIDE MEANS MORE FRUIT!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new cup of coffee, especially if it's a special blend. What is it?

ANSWER: TAKING A DEEP, APPRECIATIVE SNIFF OF THE COFFEE AROMA, SOMETIMES EVEN BEFORE ADDING MILK OR SUGAR!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular type of building' just instantly catches your eye, perhaps because of its unique architecture, its history, or just a quirky detail?
What's a building, perhaps in your local area or one you've visited, that you find truly fascinating or beautiful, and what makes it stand out for you?

- We all have that 'one small, everyday household item' that, despite its simplicity, you genuinely couldn't imagine your pantry without because it's just so useful or brings you joy, don't we?
What's that one item in your kitchen or pantry that you rely on constantly, or perhaps one that just makes you smile every time you see or use it?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Inventions.** The 'Keep Calm and Carry On' posters, now iconic, were actually designed by the British government in 1939 but were rarely displayed during World War Two.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The first ever recorded use of an umbrella for rain protection was by a Roman emperor who used a large silk canopy to shield himself during outdoor events.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is wonderfully known as a 'parliament'.
- The world's oldest known living tree is a bristlecone pine named Methuselah, estimated to be over 4,800 years old.
- The distinctive red telephone boxes in the UK were designed by Sir Giles Gilbert Scott, who also designed Liverpool Cathedral.
- The shortest war in history lasted only 38 to 45 minutes, fought between Britain and Zanzibar in 1896.
- Bananas are technically berries, while strawberries are not.
- The 'ping' sound of a microwave oven operating was originally added to make it seem more scientific and advanced.
- The game of bingo was originally called 'Beano' because players marked their cards with beans.
- There are more possible iterations of a game of chess than there are atoms in the observable universe.

On this day

Day 271 of the year, 94 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aaron of Auxerre; Christian feast day: Amalia Abad Casasepere; Christian feast day: Annemund; Christian feast day: Chariton the Confessor. Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1971 — Alan Wright, English footballer and manager
- 1965 — B.G., the Prince of Rap, American rapper (died 2023)
- 1988 — Hana Mae Lee, American actress, model, and fashion designer
- 1968 — Trish Keenan, English singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2011)
- 1967 — Mira Sorvino, American actress
- 1983 — Stefan Moore, English footballer
- 1946 — Jeffrey Jones, American actor
- 1947 — Jon Snow, English journalist and academic

THE DAY TODAY

- 2000 — Al-Aqsa Intifada: Ariel Sharon visits Al-Aqsa Mosque known to Jews as the Temple Mount in Jerusalem.
- 2008 — The Singapore Grand Prix is held as Formula One's inaugural night race, with Fernando Alonso winning the event. Almost a year later it was revealed that Alonso's team-mate Nelson Piquet Jr. had been ordered to crash his car to help bring out the safety car and give Alonso the...
- 2012 — Somali and African Union forces launch a coordinated assault on the Somali port of Kismayo to take back the city from al-Shabaab militants.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1995 — Bob Denard and a group of mercenaries take the islands of the Comoros in a coup.
- 1992 — A Pakistan International Airlines flight crashes into a hill in Nepal, killing all 167 passengers and crew.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1983 — John Pat, a 16-year old Aboriginal Australian boy, dies of injuries sustained by four off-duty police officers in Roebourne, a catalyst to the Royal Commission into Aboriginal Deaths in Custody.

- 1941 — Ted Williams achieves a .406 batting average for the season, and becomes the last major league baseball player to bat .400 or better.
- 1995 — Israeli Prime Minister Yitzhak Rabin and PLO Chairman Yasser Arafat sign the Interim Agreement on the West Bank and the Gaza Strip.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 272 of the year, 93 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Charles, Duke of Brittany; Christian feast day: Cyriacus the Anchorite; Christian feast day: Hripsime; Christian feast day: Blessed Francesc de Paula Castelló Aleu. Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1976 — Kelvin Davis, English footballer
- 1942 — Steve Tesich, Serbian-American screenwriter and playwright (died 1996)
- 1980 — Zachary Levi, American actor and singer
- 1970 — Emily Lloyd, English actress
- 1971 — Mackenzie Crook, English actor and screenwriter
- 1980 — Chrissy Metz, American actress
- 1981 — Kelly McCreary, American actress
- 1944 — Isla Blair, British actress and singer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1957 — The Kyshtym disaster is the third-worst nuclear accident ever recorded.
- 2009 — The 8.1 Mw Samoa earthquake results in a tsunami that kills over 189 and injures hundreds.
- 2019 — Violence and low turnout mar the 2019 Afghan presidential election.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1954 — The convention establishing CERN (the European Organization for Nuclear Research) is signed.
- 2004 — Burt Rutan's Ansari SpaceShipOne performs a successful spaceflight, the first of two required to win the Ansari X Prize.

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 **Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller**

FRI 23 **Frankenstein (del Toro)**

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar